Contact

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www.linkedin.com/in/jessecary (LinkedIn)

Top Skills

Engineering Consulting

iGaming

Cross-functional Team Leadership

Languages

English (Native or Bilingual)

Spanish (Elementary)

Honors-Awards

Voted Best Speaker by BITR Conf attendees

Jesse Cary

Strategic & Product Focused Technology Leader, iGaming Specialist

Newcastle Upon Tyne, England, United Kingdom

Summary

Dynamic and highly engaging technology leader with over a 12 years experience in the iGaming industry. My hands-on experience and executive view of how solutions create business value give me the ability to communicate "across the aisle" between technology and business stakeholders to manage strategies and delivery / implementation for product development and platform architectures.

Specialties: Online Gambling: Casino/Sports/Bingo/Lottery, Technical Solution Sales, Solution Architecture / Domain Driven Design, Technical Product Strategy, Technical Project Management, Scalability, API Design, Agile Software Development, Continuous Delivery, Software Integration, Distributed Systems, Microservices Architecture, Startups, Data Migrations

Experience

Self-employed

Technical Consultant

January 2025 - Present (3 months)

United Kingdom

Leveraging over 20 years of technical experience in IT, software engineering and management, I provide expert consultancy services to help organisations design, build, and optimise scalable systems and teams.

Technical Strategy: Guiding organisations to align technology implementation with core business values, respecting business stage and growth plan.

Builder Excellence & Collaboration: Driving alignment between cross-functional teams to deliver successful projects.

System Architecture: Guidance on building robust and efficient solutions, specialising in microservices, cloud-based platforms, operational excellence and business alignment.

Expertise: My 13 years of experience in the iGaming industry is also applicable to other sectors, including B2B platform design, regulated & highly transactional systems, and various integrations including payment solutions.

Fanatics, Inc.
Distinguished Engineer
April 2023 - December 2024 (1 year 9 months)

• Led team and high level design of PointsBet migration to FBG following its acquisition in 2023. Worked across infrastructure, engineering, data/ reporting, compliance, quality assurance, project management and business stakeholders until the first successful and repeatable state launch.
• Technical design leadership - leveraged existing platform frameworks for building real-time promotional, retention and sports trading tools and services.
• Advised on platform architecture and integration improvements.
• Conducted research, due diligence, proof of concept evaluations and commercial negotiation to implement engineering tools to enhance team efficiency.

Strive Gaming
Chief Technology Officer
June 2021 - March 2023 (1 year 10 months)
Newcastle upon Tyne, England, United Kingdom

As the 1st technical hire at Strive Gaming, I played a pivotal role in building the company from the ground up in its first 2 years, shaping technology strategy, and driving execution to establish it in the gaming industry.

Technical Foundations: Opened a UK office and hired technical staff there as well as Strive's North American and Malta locations to form a globally distributed team.

Technical Leadership: Worked directly with the founders to develop and execute technical strategies aligned with business goals, contributing to technical sales efforts to secure key partnerships and clients.

Software & Infrastructure Development: Collaborated with technology providers to scope, design, and implement infrastructure and systems while driving knowledge transfer to internal teams.

Hands-On Execution: Delivered operational execution, driving the growth of the technical organisation from day one.

Avantage® Entertainment
Interim Chief Technology Officer
January 2021 - June 2021 (6 months)

Launching a brand new iGaming platform with original content.

High 5 Games
Vice President Strategy
February 2020 - December 2020 (11 months)

Organisational Strategy

Reporting to the CEO, focused vision into 4 pillars combining individual & shared objectives for B2B and B2C.

Initiated a cross-functional product and development team restructure realigning to functional ownership to streamline delivery of cross-channel features and promote the target architecture in support of the business vision.

Leadership

Led Product and Architecture teams, directed technical solutions, improved governance and product vision accommodating both long term strategy and rapid market expansion

Facilitated executive prioritisation, balancing BAU with tactical and strategic decision making to rationalise priorities

Technical Strategy

Drafted a strategic roadmap to consolidate projects across business units, identify dependencies/synergies and aid quarterly capacity planning

Developed a service-based architecture vision to align ongoing tactical solution designs with strategic goals including plans for a major core platform upgrade.

Outlined a path for global infrastructure guided by architecture & market constraints.

Defined domain specific language to guide the implementation of generic tools architecture.

Clarified boundaries between analytics, server and client tiers, guided by B2B strategy considering SLAs

Created event-driven target architecture promoting clear domain separation, reactive services and real-time client messaging to support player features.

Solutions incorporated GCP (Firebase) services for cost-efficient operation and infrastructure re-use to simplify future feature work.

Delivery
Advocated SAFe practices, identified value streams, reduced WIP to focus delivery
Provided guidance, scope and high-level design for integration projects; Income Access (affiliate), NetEnt/Evolution Games/iForium (games), Bambora (payments).
Facilitated technical design sessions, status update meetings, created conventions for comms channels to ensure smooth delivery.

Bede Gaming Ltd
7 years 2 months

Head of Application Architecture
August 2018 - February 2020 (1 year 7 months)
Newcastle upon Tyne, United Kingdom

Championed a Domain-Driven Design approach for optimising micro-service architecture and a federated approach to configuration to simplify the growing complexity required to address market expansion
Led the data migration project for onboarding the Ontario Lottery to Bede's platform, including formation and management of DM team

Director of Solution Architecture
January 2017 - August 2018 (1 year 8 months)
Newcastle upon Tyne, United Kingdom

Coordinate with Bede’s Chief Commercial Officer, Product Director and Head of Client Services to ensure new products and solutions have technical oversight
Participate in RFP responses for new tenders
Advise Commercial Operations Director on new client contracts
Attend sales pitches and produce pre-sales solutions that provide win/win architecture for sales lead and platform vision
Lead proof of concepts and advise designs for technical products
Lead Bede’s Solution Architects and Technical Team Leads, ensuring solution designs stay in line with business and technical strategies

Technical Director
January 2013 - January 2017 (4 years 1 month)

As Technical Director from Bede's inception, I played a number of key roles helping take Bede Gaming from startup to industry standout.

Agile Software Delivery
I helped champion several iterations of agile transformation, adapting as the business quickly scaled, driving adoption of tooling which I administered with policies which put Bede on a path toward continuous delivery and organisational scalability.

Software Architecture and Design
Provided architectural guidance for the platform during early iterations and leveraged my experience in syndicated services to advance my vision for Bede as an open platform through forward-thinking API management solutions.
Championed the use of micro-services architecture and asynchronous system design leveraging Azure PaaS services to deliver scalable services at high velocity.
Liased between business stakeholders and development teams, using domain-driven design and LEAN principles to de-risk product initiatives.
Created the product vision and proof of concept of our Live Data analytics tool.

Technical Programme Management
Acted as Bede's Technical Programme Manager for the Rank Group's migration to our platform, an industry first migration of a "Tier 1" operator. As part of the programme, I concurrently acted as:
- Principle Solution Architect for all platform API integrations and advisor to Rank's Enterprise Services team
- Product Owner of Bede API Layer
- Technical Project Manager for the customer account data migration and internal native iOS app build projects
- Technical Account Manager supporting a separate iOS native app build by an independent agency

Newcastle Marketing Services Ltd
Technical Architect / Technical Director
October 2011 - December 2012 (1 year 3 months)

Led design decisions of greenfield platform architecture
Provided analysis and solutions for external system integrations; IGT Games, Worldpay, Bally's
Implemented scalable engineering best practices; continuous integration and deployment, testing automation

Comcast Interactive Media

Web Software Engineer
April 2009 - October 2011 (2 years 7 months)

Java middleware development for syndicated services; created syndication feeds for the CodeBig API platform and embeddable widgets utilising platform APIs and OAuth

Web development (PHP/HTML/CSS/Javascript) for Alternate Platform Product Development team; created desktop and mobile listings/PVR grids, designed the internal Labs site, concept Firefox PVR plugins

Vodafone
Support Analyst
April 2008 - March 2009 (1 year)
Auckland, New Zealand

Provided support for 2G, 3G, HSDPA network issues

Unisys
Software Developer
2004 - 2006 (2 years)
Malvern, PA

ASP.net development, Perl scripting, Rational Software Process Administration

Northeast High School, Philadelphia
Network Administrator
September 2003 - May 2004 (9 months)

Managed and supported a 3700+ user, 400+ computer Windows network

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Education

Drexel University
Bachelor of Science (BSc), Information Science and Technology · (2001 - 2006)